

THE RECONCILIATION TAX CHECKLIST

Audit your donor, partner, and programme data before it costs you — a working checklist, not a theory. Go through each section with your actual data open. Jeffrey Uwoghiren — CRM Architect, jeffreyuwoghiren@gmail.com

1. DATA SOURCE INVENTORY

- List every place donor, partner, or programme data currently lives — including spreadsheets, shared drives, and paper logs, not just the 'main' system.
- For each source, note who owns it and how often it's updated.
- Flag any source with no clear owner — these are the ones most likely to drift out of sync.

2. FIELD CONSISTENCY

- Compare field names for the same data across sources (e.g. 'Region' vs 'State' vs 'Branch').
- Check date formats match across every source (DD/MM/YYYY vs MM/DD/YYYY is a common silent break).
- Check currency fields specify a currency, not just a number.
- Confirm required fields (donor name, ID, reporting period) are actually mandatory at entry, not optional.

3. DUPLICATE RISK

- Search for the same donor or partner entered under slightly different names across sources.
- Check whether your system has duplicate/matching rules configured on key identifying fields.
- Confirm there's a defined process for merging duplicates once found — not just flagging them.

4. ACCESS & SECURITY

- Confirm sensitive records (case data, health information, protection files) are restricted to people who need them.
- Check whether any sensitive data is currently moving through email attachments or messaging apps.
- Confirm field-level permissions match your organization's actual confidentiality requirements.

5. REPORTING READINESS

- Time how long it currently takes to produce one consolidated, donor-ready number.

- Identify every manual step required to get from raw data to a reportable figure.
 - Confirm dashboards or report types exist that a non-technical team member could pull without help.
 - Note the last time a 'final' number had to be revised after being shared — and why.
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If more than a few boxes above stay unchecked, the gap is usually structural, not a training issue — worth a proper CRM architecture conversation before the next reporting cycle. jeffreyuwoghiren@gmail.com